

## Chapter 161-2

【Ugh, I thought it was Yang Shuyan. Is this D-list celebrity<sup>1</sup> trying to ride on the hype too?】

【The person above is wrong. I checked and she only has a minor role in an upcoming drama. Calling her D-list is already giving her too much credit.】

【Is this photo even that good-looking? Why can't I see it?】

【Honestly, I really don't think she's good-looking. That red outfit look from before was also just average. She's like eight hundred Zhao Yings away from Yang Shuyan.】

【Hey, if you want to talk, just talk. Why drag others down to lift someone up?<sup>2</sup>】

【.....】

Almost everyone had only seen the photos released by the production team.

It wasn't stunning at all—it wasn't even as good as the passerby perspective photos on Weibo before.

With filters applied, her looks dropped drastically. Plus, the outfit had no memorable features, making people have no desire to watch.

But Liang Shi wasn't affected. She only posted a promotional Weibo post at her agent's request and didn't pay any more attention. Then that evening, she found Zhao Xuning watching TV, and it happened to be the variety show she was on.

Liang Shi: "?"

"Let's not watch this," Liang Shi said.

Zhao Xuning was puzzled: "Why?"

"It's not good," Liang Shi said.

She really didn't want to die of embarrassment in front of Zhao Xuning.

And she was genuinely afraid that someone like Zhao Xuning—a top student who never took the conventional path—would see her doing fan dancing and decide she needed to buy a fan and learn it too.

"I think it's quite good," Zhao Xuning said. "I watch it every week."

Liang Shi: "....."

"You really don't look like someone who'd enjoy watching this kind of variety show." Liang Shi opened the fridge, took out two cans of cold beer, and tossed one over to her.

Zhao Xuning caught it, popped it open with a click, then shrugged lightly. "Shen Hui used to like watching it."

So she watched along.

Most of the time, Shen Hui watched the variety show while she watched Shen Hui. When bored, she'd play with her hair, or hold her in her arms and feed her food.

Back then, Shen Hui always complained, "This is exactly how you've been fattening me up!"

She would pinch Shen Hui's waist and say, "I like it."

And then greedily bury her face in Shen Hui's neck, kissing the fresh scent of her hair tips like sniffing a cat.

Shen Hui had nestled in her arms watching many episodes of this show, so she had also developed the habit of watching it.

When two people stayed together for a long time, they really did become similar in certain ways.

Just like before, Zhao Xuning didn't like spicy food, but after being with Shen Hui, she could handle spicy food.

Zhao Xuning also didn't like exercising, but Shen Hui did—running, swimming, crunches, Pilates, yoga—so Zhao Xuning had trained with her too.

The most ridiculous thing was that Zhao Xuning, someone with completely uncoordinated limbs, had even learned street dance with Shen Hui.

Back then, she often said that when Shen Hui danced, it was beautiful, but when she danced, it was like a little demon coming for your life<sup>3</sup>.

Even after they separated, Zhao Xuning would watch this variety show every week whenever she had time.

Even when she was exhausted, she would keep this variety show on as background noise.

Before Liang Shi spoke up, she really hadn't expected Liang Shi to be on this show.

Liang Shi simply gave up and sat next to her to watch together.

The opening featured a senior actor from their company singing a love song duet with the show's host.

The pitch wasn't great, but the vocal tone was nice.

When Liang Shi's dance segment came on, after watching it, Zhao Xuning took a sip of beer and gave a rare compliment: "Not bad."

Meanwhile on Weibo, the clip of her dancing had made it to the hot search, and the public opinion had completely shifted.

Before the broadcast, she had been criticized as ugly because of the photos and solo promotional images released by the production team. Now the comment section was full of praise.

【This is something I can watch for free?】

【Did you all look carefully? At the 22-second mark when she raises her arm, she has abs!】

【Saw it, screenshotted it! Image.jpg】

【It's mainly her eyes though. Wuwuwu I instantly got her beauty!】

【I just want to ask—you stupid show, are you deliberately sabotaging yourselves?!】

【Yes yes yes! After watching the video and then looking at the photos, I want to kill the production team.】

【.....】

Liang Shi's Weibo followers grew extremely fast—she gained 100,000 followers in less than an hour.

At the same time, on the other side of the city, Xu Qingzhu had returned home and was curled up on the sofa, spacing out.

Her phone beside her buzzed. It was a message from Sally.

Sally: 【...Your Liang Shi is too beautiful.】

Sally: 【Is there a solo fancam? I have a friend who wants to see it.】

Xu Qingzhu: 【?】

She had no idea what Sally was talking about, so Sally forwarded her a Weibo post.

After Liang Shi left, Xu Qingzhu rarely opened Weibo.

Especially her side account.

She was afraid that after seeing her news, she wouldn't be able to resist contacting her. Even more afraid that after seeing her updates, she wouldn't dare to contact her.

So she simply avoided it altogether.

When she opened it now, she saw the video of Liang Shi dancing in red. On stage, she was different from when acting—every movement was perfect. Even though there weren't many shots of her, whenever the camera panned to her, she seemed to radiate her own light.

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## Footnotes:

<sup>1</sup> **D-list celebrity (十八線):** Literally "eighteenth-tier," this is Chinese internet slang for extremely minor or unknown celebrities. The entertainment industry hierarchy is often described in "tiers" (線), with first-tier being the most famous. "Eighteenth-tier" essentially means someone with virtually no fame.

<sup>2</sup> **Drag others down to lift someone up (拉踩):** A common Chinese internet term meaning to criticize or put down one person/thing in order to praise another. It's considered poor behavior in fan communities.

<sup>3</sup> **Little demon coming for your life (小鬼索命):** A humorous Chinese expression meaning something is so bad or chaotic it's like a vengeful spirit has come to claim your soul. Here it's used self-deprecatingly to describe terrible dancing.